



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Relationships are hard work, don't you think?



## Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing.
- I can encourage agreement.
- I can talk about what I do, did or have done.

## Ask your partner:

- What is one of the most romantic stories you've ever heard?
- What do you think is the secret for lasting relationships?





## Let's Explore!

Paula's parents are such **lovebirds**\*! It's a heartwarming love story.

\* "Lovebirds" are a type of parrot. They are very affectionate and loving birds who spend their entire lives with their loved one.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Peter:** Your parents' story is so heartwarming, Paula. In fact, it's one of the most romantic stories I've heard in a while.
- Paula:** I know! They've been in love for so long. They've shared so many experiences together. In fact, they still find the time to do new things. There is always something for them to do out on the town. Don't you think it's wonderful to have a soulmate?
- Peter:** I guess ... I thought I found my soulmate when I met Camilla. We got along so well. Of course, it wasn't meant to be. Don't you think that successful relationships are rare these days?
- Paula:** I'm not sure I agree. I've met many happy couples. Of course, I've also comforted many girlfriends after their breakups. I think it's important to be clear about what you want in a relationship as early as possible.
- Peter:** That's true. No one really understands my passion for comics and movies, for example. In fact, most of my dates have been fiascos because of that.
- Paula:** You have to admit that it's a very specific conversation topic. Don't you think you should branch out a little?
- Peter:** I tried that, of course, but it didn't work either.
- Paula:** You sound desperate.
- Peter:** Of course I do! It's not easy being a geek!





## Let's Practice!

### Heartwarming Vocabulary.

*Instructions: Find the words and phrases about Heartwarming in the wordsearch. Read the definitions and find the words.*

1. emotionally uplifting
2. a complete failure
3. someone you have a deep affinity with
4. make someone feel better
5. try new things to gain something

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## Let's Practice!

### Expressing feelings of love.

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Mark with a circle the correct tense of each sentence. There is only one answer per question. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.*

1. I found my soulmate. Present / Past / Present Perfect
2. It's one of the most romantic stories I've heard in a while. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)
3. No one understands my passion for comics and movies. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)
4. I've met many happy couples. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)
5. They've been in love for so long. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)
6. I met many happy couples last summer. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)
7. I tried that, of course. (Present / Past / Present Perfect)





## Extension Activity

Have some movie stars changed over the years?

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Research a famous movie star that you find interesting.
- How has your movie star's life changed in the last ten years?
- Include their dating history and who they are dating now.
- Use the present perfect, past and present simple tenses.
- Share with a partner.
- Encourage your partner to ask negative questions that encourage agreement like *Don't you think ... ?*

### Self-Assessment

**Yes** **No**

I identify the main points of an actor's life.

☐ ☐

I use encourage agreement questions.

☐ ☐

I can talk about what someone does, did or has done.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **heartwarming** (adjective): emotionally uplifting  
e.g. Your parents have been in love for 50 years. It's a heartwarming love story.
- **soulmate** (noun): a person with whom someone has a deep affinity; life companion  
e.g. Don't you think it's wonderful to have a soulmate?
- **it wasn't meant to be** (expression): circumstances prevented the intended outcome from happening  
e.g. I really liked Camilla, but it didn't work out. It wasn't meant to be.
- **to branch out** (verb): to try out new things in order to gain something  
e.g. You always try the same things. Don't you think you should branch out a little?
- **to comfort** (verb): to make someone feel better about a situation; to console  
e.g. I've comforted many girlfriends after their breakups.
- **fiasco** (noun): a complete failure  
e.g. Most of my dates have been fiascos because of my passion for comics.





## Learning Points

### Negative Questions To Encourage Agreement

Negative questions have a different meaning than regular questions.

You use negative questions to confirm information you already know, like *Don't you think ...* ?

Negative questions can have two different meanings.

You can ask a negative question for confirmation of a positive belief.  
You can ask a negative question for confirmation of a negative belief.

#### Examples:

- *Don't you think it's wonderful to have a soulmate?*
- *Don't you think that successful relationships are rare these days?*
- *Don't you think you should branch out a little?*
- *Don't you think that long distance relationships are doomed?*

### Simple Present vs. Present Perfect vs. Simple Past

1. You use the Simple Present to talk about things that are true and things that you do regularly in the present.
2. You use the Present Perfect for actions which started in the past and are still happening now OR for finished actions which have a connection to the present.
3. You use the Simple Past for past events or actions which have no connection to the present.

| Rule                                                                                   | Example                                                                              | Explanation                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| The <b>Simple Present</b> is used when the action is always true or happens regularly. | <i>Of course I sound desperate!<br/>No one understands my passion for comics.</i>    | The time period IS the present and is true all the time. |
| The <b>Present Perfect</b> is used when the time period has NOT finished.              | <i>In fact, most of my dates have been fiascos because of my passion for comics.</i> | The time period goes up to the present.                  |
| The <b>Simple Past</b> is used when the time period HAS finished.                      | <i>We got along so well. Of course, it wasn't meant to be.</i>                       | The time period has finished.                            |